

Test 1 Key

Reading and Use of English (1 hour 15 minutes)

Part 1

1 D 2 D 3 A 4 C 5 B 6 B 7 A 8 D

Part 2

9 of 10 one 11 whether/if 12 Because 13 have 14 from
15 in 16 rather

Part 3

17 variety 18 emotional 19 satisfaction 20 impossible
21 importance 22 creativity 23 preparation 24 pleasure

Part 4

25 HAS a shower | before going
26 if she | had not / hadn't BEEN OR had she | not BEEN
27 not go / be / be put / be going | on SALE
28 eats / will eat / likes all VEGETABLES | apart
29 have/get the/his spelling | CHECKED by
30 EXCUSE me (for)/my | disturbing

Part 5

31 A 32 D 33 B 34 D 35 A 36 A

Part 6

37 F 38 C 39 E 40 G 41 B 42 D

Part 7

43 C 44 A 45 D 46 B 47 D 48 D 49 C 50 B 51 B 52 A

Writing (1 hour 20 minutes)

Candidate responses are marked using the assessment scale on pages 107–108.

Listening (approximately 40 minutes)

Part 1

1 A 2 A 3 B 4 B 5 B 6 C 7 B 8 C

Part 2

9 father 10 humour/humor 11 plants 12 (physical) size
13 panic 14 (plastic) bags 15 knife 16 river
17 fire (without matches) 18 (being good at) time management

Part 3

19 G 20 F 21 A 22 H 23 C

Part 4

24 C 25 A 26 C 27 C 28 C 29 B 30 A

Transcript

This is the Cambridge English: First Listening Test. Test One.

I'm going to give you the instructions for this test. I'll introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you will hear this sound:

tone

You'll hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you're listening, write your answers on the question paper. You'll have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

Test 1 Key

PART 1 *You'll hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).*

Question 1 *You hear a woman talking on the radio about an actor.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: Like many actors, he always seems to be in the news for one reason or another. I know celebrities can be given a tough time, but he seems to get off relatively lightly. He's in loads of movies these days – and so he should be. His performances were fairly patchy when he was starting out, in my opinion, but that's never the case these days. And the signs are he'll continue to develop, especially now he's getting to play lead roles in popular theatre productions, too. If you ever get the chance to see him on stage, you won't be disappointed. Otherwise, catch him at a cinema near you!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2 *You hear a hairstylist talking about her career.*

[pause]

tone

Man: You initially started off doing the hair of models in the fashion industry. What made you move to TV?

Woman: The fashion industry turned me off quite a bit actually. I didn't like working with people who had such a high opinion of themselves. My attitude is that you should treat everyone the same and I found I was constantly having to bite my tongue because of the way I was treated there. The TV's different: it's much more a case of being respected for what you can offer regardless of your status ... and that suits me. The TV people acknowledge you as a fellow professional and they're much more down-to-earth.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 3 You hear a comedian called Geoff Knight talking on the radio about his profession.

[pause]

tone

Man: When I'm doing my comedy act, at theatres or clubs or on TV, I'll often get my ideas from keeping my ears close to the ground. I try to pick up on all the strange and humorous everyday stuff, sometimes even boring ... that you get in life ... and I build it into my act. Obviously I do also get ideas from listening to other comedians too. I like to think that three generations of one family can sit at my show and know they won't feel threatened, because I'm not rude. Even in big arenas people feel like I'm talking to them individually. It's a comfort thing for them.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 4 You hear a conversation between a customer and a coffee shop employee.

[pause]

tone

Woman: Excuse me. Could someone come over and clear one of the tables in the window please?

Man: Oh yes. I'm sorry. We've just had a really busy lunch break and, between you and me, my colleague's new and hasn't really got the hang of things yet.

Woman: Yes, you look as if you've been really busy.

Man: We should be able to get straight now it's a bit quieter. I'll get my colleague to come and clear your table right away.

Woman: Hmmm ... It certainly needs it!

Man: Anyway, what can I get you? Coffee and cake or ...

Woman: I'll just have coffee please.

Man: And I'll get a cloth to wipe the table.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 1 Key

Question 5 *You hear a man telling a friend about an art exhibition.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: Hi Mark, how did you like the exhibition?

Man: It was alright, actually. I've got the catalogue here. Would you like to have a look?

Woman: I don't usually bother with them, personally. They've always felt like a bit of a waste of money.

Man: I know what you mean, but somebody lent me this one.

Woman: So ... what's the gallery like?

Man: Really cool, using natural light to show off the paintings – saves energy too, you know ...

Woman: I expect it was crowded.

Man: Well, I'd expected there to be masses of people, so I wouldn't be able to see anything. In fact, I nearly had the place to myself.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6 *You overhear a man ringing a sports shop.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Hello. Colin Foggerty here. I was in the shop last week, and bought a pair of the new Comfort football boots. I asked about a discount I'd heard about for members of Kirkley Rangers football club, which I'm a member of. The assistant was by herself and said she didn't know anything about it. I then checked on the football club website, and it confirms what I thought. I emailed you at the shop this morning and was told that the shop gives special discounts for official club purchases, but I'm still not sure whether the discount is applicable to ordinary club members like me. So I thought I'd better ring and sort it all out.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 7 *You hear a man telling a friend about his work.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: So you've been at the company for five years, how do you feel it's going?

Man: Well, the boss sees me as someone who'll go far but I don't really know if I want to. I mean I've seen what happened to Joe who was promoted last year to sales manager. At the time, I thought 'lucky him', but he isn't enjoying it. The working environment isn't as friendly and supportive as it was when I first joined – mainly because of all the targets we've been set. Sad that management feels the need to play with what was a winning formula. Still, let's see what the future brings.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 8 *You hear two people talking about a country walk they're doing.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Are you feeling tired?

Woman: No, I'm fine, just stopping to look at the scenery. It's beautiful, isn't it?

Man: Fabulous, but keep moving – it's too cold to stand still.

Woman: Well, we knew that when we set off. The forecast's better for tomorrow. I did say we should wait.

Man: Sorry, I know, but let's carry on because there's only another five kilometres to go. Right or left here?

Woman: Left, I think, according to the map. Five kilometres you said? It'll be just about dark when we get to the end.

Man: If we do get there! I'm only joking!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That's the end of Part One.

Now turn to Part Two.

[pause]

Test 1 Key

PART 2

You'll hear a presentation given by a university student called Megan Rowlings about a forest survival course she went on in Australia. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

Hi, my name's Megan and I'm going to tell you about a forest survival course in Australia. So how did I come to do a course like that? Well, I'd been thinking about what to do in my summer holiday and my professor suggested I should do some teaching at a summer camp he was running, but I wanted to get away from academic stuff for a while. Then my father found the website about survival courses while looking for something to interest my brother. And that was it!

The course leader, John, was a very experienced survival expert with an impressive range of skills. I can't tell you how absolutely terrifying the experience of being in the forest was at times but John's humour eased the tension, for which I was really grateful. He also knew exactly when to offer support and when to leave us to it.

Chris was his assistant, and he brought different qualities to the group. He was never short of enthusiasm, and was particularly keen on insects – he told us the name of every one we came across in the forest. He also knew all the facts about plants so that over the five days, we got to know what was safe to eat while we were there and what we had to avoid. That information proved really valuable.

There were ten of us on the course and we made a great team. I thought I'd struggle with the tasks that made big physical demands because of my size, but I soon learnt that mental toughness was equally important. And in fact that turned out to be something I didn't have a problem with.

John drilled into us the importance of staying safe at all times. In that respect, possessing sufficient self-awareness is key ... knowing our own capabilities and limitations could save our lives. All this holds back panic, which is often a greater danger than the situations we find ourselves in.

We'd all been equipped with a mini survival kit which contained things like a first aid kit and water sterilisation tablets, and of course we'd all brought other things as well, including some fancy gadgets which were never used ... but nobody else had thought about plastic bags to keep stuff dry in our rucksacks. I passed mine around and they were much appreciated.

Our first task was to make tools that we could use. For example, did you know you can actually make a spear from a branch if it's strong enough? We were shown how to make a knife out of a stone that was lying on the forest floor. It took me quite a long time to make one but it was great for all sorts of tasks.

The next thing was to find a water source. We found a small stream and we followed that some distance to where it finally joined a river. John told us that because the water at that point was quite fast-flowing, it was drinkable as long as we boiled it. There was also a small lake nearby but we were advised not to use that because of the wild animals that were often there.

Our first meal in the forest was what we collected ourselves, such as berries. Then, after all that walking and looking for food, we were ready for a good night's sleep. I didn't find making a shelter too problematic actually, which was just as well because if lighting a fire without matches had been left to me, then we'd have been shivering all night!

The thing that I found most interesting about the course was that many of the skills I use as a student at university are invaluable for survival too. Of course, you'd expect team-building to be useful. But what I hadn't expected was that being good at time management would also be an advantage.

[pause]

Now you'll hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That's the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

[pause]

PART 3

You'll hear five short extracts in which people talk about a problem they had in their first few weeks in a new job. For questions 19 to 23, choose what problem (A to H) each speaker says they had. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

Well I work for an IT company and I love it because it's really stimulating. I work hard but the rewards are there. At the same time it's quite laid back – at least where the dress code is concerned anyway. My first few weeks were great. My friend works in the adjoining building so we often had lunch together. The problem was, she had a longer lunch break than me and I started wandering back a few minutes over the hour. I didn't think anyone would notice but my colleagues soon had a quiet word with me – in the nicest possible way of course! I don't do that anymore.

[pause]

Speaker 2

My first job was for a finance company. I'd beaten off quite a few candidates to get the job and I was riding high. I'd bought a new suit and briefcase and walked in there on the first day thinking 'This is it. Now I'm going to show them what I'm made of.' I thought I knew it all. I'd correct colleagues if they said something wrong and I was always talking about what I'd learnt at university. Anyway, in my fourth week the boss called me in and told me I'd done something that had lost the company quite a lot of money. I learnt a lot that day.

[pause]

Speaker 3

I worked for a small company locally. It was my first job back after maternity leave and I was really glad to be back at work. I got on well with my colleagues and the work was fine, but I really didn't like the boss. Anyway, I got quite friendly in the first few weeks with the receptionist. She was a nice young girl – very chatty. She asked me how I was getting on and I said I really liked the job and everything, but not the boss. Stupid I know. Anyway, it turns out that the receptionist was the boss's niece! Small world. I should've noticed their surnames were the same!

[pause]

Speaker 4

Well, I didn't really need the job in the supermarket. You know, I was retired and just wanted something to fill the time and the extra money was useful. I'd been a manager for an engineering company in the past so I knew how things worked. I did my job. I was always on time. But I resented being told to do things that weren't in my job description, and I didn't think that was fair. I didn't say anything but I think they knew I wasn't happy. In the end, I decided I didn't fit in. On reflection, I think retirement suits me better.

[pause]

Speaker 5

I've never been very confident so I was really surprised when I was offered a job in a very posh law company. I decided to really show them that I was up to doing the job, but I went a bit too far – volunteering to do everything, taking clients' names and details home to memorise so I could greet them by name when they came in and so on. I overdid it actually because I wasn't being myself. After a few weeks, my colleagues told me to relax and that I was doing fine as I was. I didn't need to prove anything. I love my job now.

[pause]

Now you'll hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That's the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

[pause]